

EVAN PARNELL

Laboratory Operations Executive | Multi-Site Technical Services | ISO/IEC 17025

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EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Laboratory operations executive with **14 years in commercial analytical laboratories** — environmental, pharmaceutical and regulated cannabis testing — spanning laboratory startup, ISO/IEC 17025 accreditation, quality-system ownership and multi-site operational leadership.

I run the inside of a laboratory: throughput, turnaround, quality discipline, capacity, cost per sample, and the people who deliver it. I have built two laboratories from an empty building through accreditation and commercial operation, rebuilt a quality system after a failed external audit, and doubled the annual volume of a high-throughput laboratory while cutting both turnaround time and turnover. My work is the same in every setting: find the constraint keeping a technically excellent laboratory from performing commercially, then build the operating system that removes it and keeps it removed.

SELECTED RESULTS

- **Grew annual testing volume from ~25,000 to ~47,000 samples** — 27,000 / 33,000 / 39,000 / 47,000 by year — while staff grew from **32 to 45 (+40%)**, roughly a third more output per person
- **Turnaround time reduced from 5 days to 3 days** in a market where clients choose on speed and defensibility
- **Turnover reduced from 12 departures per year to 4** through a competency-based job leveling framework with published pay bands and skill checklists
- **Two laboratories accredited to ISO/IEC 17025**; one also licensed for DEA controlled substances. **ISO 9001 system** built after an unsuccessful external audit. **Audited dozens of times across three organizations at a ~97% success rate** — A2LA, PJLA, IAS, FDA, DEA and state programs
- **\$1M+ financing secured** for a greenfield laboratory build, carried through construction, validation and launch
- **Operating costs reduced ~15% while expanding capabilities**, and a 30% sales increase with a 40% cost reduction in four months at an earlier laboratory during a leadership transition

CORE COMPETENCIES

Laboratory Operations · P&L and Budget Ownership · ISO/IEC 17025 · ISO 9001 · Method Validation · Accreditation and Regulatory Readiness · Throughput and Turnaround Optimization · Capacity Planning · Multi-Site Leadership · Workforce Development and Retention · KPI Systems and Management Cadence · SOP Architecture · Laboratory Design and Workflow · Facility and Capital Projects · Purchasing Analysis · Chain of Custody and Data Defensibility

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Instrumentation and methods: HPLC · LC-MS/MS · GC-MS/MS · ICP-MS · ICP-OES · qPCR · Total Aerobic Count · Total Yeast and Mold Count · pathogen detection and confirmation · pesticide residues · heavy metals · residual solvents · potency · terpenes

Matrices: water and liquid samples of all types (drinking, ground, surface, waste) · soil · agricultural inputs · surface and air environmental monitoring for microbials, pesticides and heavy metals · pharmaceutical drug product and pharmaceutical environmental · cannabis and hemp

Quality and compliance: ISO/IEC 17025 · ISO 9001 · method validation and verification · demonstration of capability · proficiency testing · CAPA · state regulatory programs · DEA registration

Controlled environments (early career): cleanroom certification · ASHRAE 110 fume hood testing · HEPA/HEGA filtration · pharmaceutical, healthcare, semiconductor and nuclear facilities

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Associate Laboratory Director

Green Analytics MD, LLC

November 2021 – 2026

Owned all internal operations of a high-throughput regulated analytical laboratory — people, workflow, throughput, quality practice and facility — partnered with a Laboratory Director who owned technical specialty and external relationships.

- Led a site organization of **40–45 people** through a middle-management cadre of five — department managers across chemistry, microbiology and sampling, plus shift leads — with roughly sixteen analysts and technicians beneath them.

- **Grew annual volume from ~25,000 to ~47,000 samples on a staff that went from 32 to 45** — about a third more output per person — by analyzing workflow and purchasing, redesigning the physical laboratory around how samples move, and building a management layer accountable for its own results. **Cut turnaround from five days to three**, and reduced operating costs ~15% while expanding service capability.
- **Reduced turnover from twelve departures a year to four** by designing a job-leveling and competency framework — Technician I–III and Analyst I–III with published pay ranges, skill checklists and supervisor sign-off — replacing a structure where identical titles carried widely different pay and responsibility.
- Built management infrastructure **adopted across eight laboratories and 250+ employees on a \$10M operating budget** — job architecture, workforce development, operating procedures, career progression and leadership development — carried enterprise-wide through influence rather than formal authority as the company grew toward ~350 people.
- Built and taught a management-development curriculum for middle managers covering accountability, retention and psychological safety; moved the culture from blame to ownership.
- Held local authority for pricing, capital requests and headcount. Served as site facility manager: contractors, capital projects and laboratory redesign for throughput. Monitored method-level pass/fail excursions as a leading quality indicator.

Co-Founder & Managing Partner

2019 – 2021

Atlas Labs FL, LLC

Built a greenfield analytical laboratory end to end — market selection and financing through construction, accreditation and operational readiness.

- Secured **more than \$1M in financing**; led facility design and construction, equipment procurement, installation and validation.
- Achieved **ISO/IEC 17025 accreditation** and **DEA registration** for controlled substances, with the method validation, documentation and quality infrastructure behind both — through the COVID-19 disruption.

Technical Manager | Quality Manager

2017 – 2019

Atlantic Test Labs, Inc.

Launched an ISO/IEC 17025 analytical laboratory serving Maryland's newly regulated cannabis market.

- Led implementation of the **ISO/IEC 17025 quality management system** — accreditation, method validation, documentation and regulatory readiness — and directed startup: equipment selection, workflow design, training and operating systems.
- During a leadership transition, contributed to a **30% increase in sales and 40% reduction in operating costs across four months**.

Field Service Technician → Technical Manager → Quality Manager

2012 – 2017

Atlantic Technical Services, Inc.

Joined a \$400K field-services company as a technician and progressively assumed its most complex technical and operational responsibilities as it became a regulated laboratory business; acquired in 2019.

- Helped build **one of Maryland's first pharmaceutical microbiology laboratories of its kind**, expanding the company from field services into regulated laboratory testing.
- **Re-engineered the operating system after an unsuccessful external audit**, implementing ISO 9001 and rebuilding the procedural infrastructure behind it. Became the primary resource for controlled-environment certification, regulatory compliance and technician development.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE AND EDUCATION

Dann Marine Towing — Able Seaman / Deckhand, 2010–2012. **United States Navy** — Surface Warfare Officer, USS McFaul (DDG-74), 2008–2010.

Bachelor of Science, Chemistry — United States Naval Academy, 2008